

- **Modems** help process the signal into your home. DSL, satellite, and cable modems are not interchangeable.
- **Routers** create in-home W-Fi and allow multiple devices to use the internet at the same time.
- **Wireless Hotspots** do not need a modem or a router; these are the devices used by carriers like Verizon and AT&T for their wireless internet service.

And probably the most important term of all:

- **Mbps, or Megabits per second.** The higher the Mbps, the faster your internet, but you'll also pay more for your plan. Anything below 10 Mbps will most likely not be good enough for streaming TV shows on Netflix or Hulu, but would be fine for regular surfing. We currently have 10 Mbps and although it's not incredibly fast, it works for us and helps keep costs low.

FYI: If your plan says Gbps, you have blazing fast internet. Unless you are an online gamer (or there is one in your house), you have plenty of room to cut back, and you won't even notice the difference.

As you research various bundles and plans, refer to these terms so you're not blindsided by a price or package you don't quite understand. Knowledge is power!

2. BUNDLE UP

Usually, you can get a better deal by combining your internet with a cable or phone package offered by the same company. But you should still read the fine print and do a little math before you make a final commitment.

Sure, you might get an awesome price for the type of service the company is offering, but do you really need to pay extra for 500 channels and a